

WEEKLY CA: 30th May – 5th June 2026

1. The theme of World No Tobacco Day 2026 is:

विश्व तंबाकू निषेध दिवस 2026 का विषय है:

- (a) Commit to Quit
- (b) Tobacco: Threat to Our Environment
- (c) Protecting Children from Tobacco Industry Interference
- (d) Unmasking the Appeal – Countering Nicotine and Tobacco Addiction

Answer: (d)

31st May: World No-Tobacco Day

- The Member States of the **World Health Organization** created **World No Tobacco Day in 1987** to draw global attention to the tobacco epidemic and the preventable death and disease it causes.
- In 1987, the World Health Assembly passed Resolution - calling for **7 April 1988** to be a "a world no-smoking day."
- In 1988, Resolution was passed, calling for the celebration of World No Tobacco Day, every year on 31 May.
- **THEME: Unmasking the appeal – countering nicotine and tobacco addiction**



Date	Day	Theme
30th May	Hindi Journalism Day	
30th May	International Day of Potato	
1st June	World Milk Day	
1st June	Global Day of Parents	
2nd June	Telangana Formation Day	
3rd June	World Bicycle Day	
5th June	World Environment Day	"Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future"
5th June	International Day for the Fight against Illegal Unreported and Unregulated Fishing	

2. "Mission Queen Pineapple" is primarily aimed at promoting the GI-tagged Queen Pineapple of:

"मिशन क्वीन पाइनएप्पल" का मुख्य उद्देश्य, GI-टैग प्राप्त क्वीन पाइनएप्पल को बढ़ावा देना है:

- (a) Assam
- (b) Meghalaya
- (c) Mizoram
- (d) Tripura

Answer: (d)

Mission Queen Pineapple

- The Union Ministry for the Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER), in collaboration with the Government of Tripura, recently launched "Mission Queen Pineapple,



- It is designed for promoting Tripura's Unique Selling Proposition (USP) — **the GI-tagged Queen Pineapple**.
- **Objective:** It has an objective of establishing an integrated pineapple value-chain ecosystem in the State.
- The initiative aims to address structural gaps and unlock the premium market potential for Tripura's Queen Pineapple, transforming discarded leaves into wealth.
- **Time Period:** The Mission is designed as a **three-year implementation roadmap from Q2 FY2026 to Q4 FY2028** for promoting Tripura's Unique Selling Proposition (USP),
- **Nodal Ministry:** Minister for the Development of North Eastern Region

Key Facts about Queen Pineapple

- It is a spiny, golden-yellow variety known for its sweet taste, pleasant aroma, juicy flesh, and rich nutritional value.
- It **contains vitamins A, B, and C, as well as minerals such as calcium, magnesium, potassium, and iron.**
- It is **also the state fruit of Tripura.**
- It received the Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2015.

3. The High-Powered Committee constituted to review the Aravalli Hills report is headed by:

अरावली पहाड़ियों की रिपोर्ट की समीक्षा के लिए गठित उच्च-स्तरीय समिति की अध्यक्षता किसके द्वारा की जाती है?

- (a) Kanchan Devi
(b) Bhupender Yadav
(c) Jagdish Krishnaswamy
(d) Laxmikant Sharma

Answer: (a)

Supreme Court forms high-powered expert panel to re-examine Aravalli definition

- The Supreme Court has constituted a high-powered committee to conduct an **independent review of the Centre's report on the definition and delineation of the Aravalli hill range and directed the panel to address what it described as "critical ambiguities"**
- In November 2025, the Supreme Court had accepted the definition of the Aravallis as proposed by a committee constituted by the government on its orders. According to this definition, only peaks that are 100 metres or above would be considered as Aravallis.
- The decision sparked a controversy, after which the **Supreme Court on December 29, 2025, directed that the November decision "be kept in abeyance" till an HPC of domain experts undertakes a comprehensive assessment of the report of the earlier committee and sought proposals from all stakeholders on who should be part of the committee.**
- **The committee headed by Kanchan Devi, Director General of the Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE),** has been directed to submit a comprehensive report by August 31, 2026.
- The newly constituted high-powered committee (HPC) will be an autonomous institution functioning under the Environment Ministry.
- The Court also appointed Professor Jagdish Krishnaswamy of the Indian Institute for Human Settlements, Bengaluru, and Prof. Laxmikant Sharma of the Central University of Haryana as special invitees .

The HPC has been tasked with examining several key questions arising from the October 2025 report.

- Whether restricting the Aravalli definition to areas within a 500-metre gap between hills reduces protected area and enables mining or other environmentally harmful activities.



- Whether Aravalli hills above 100 metres elevation form a continuous ecological system even when separated by more than 500 metres, and whether mining should be allowed in such gaps.
- **Whether the report's claim that only 1,038 of Rajasthan's 12,081 hills meet the 100-metre elevation criterion is accurate.**

4. The RudraM-II missile belongs to which of the following categories?

रुद्रम-II मिसाइल निम्नलिखित में से किस श्रेणी से संबंधित है?

- (a) Surface-to-Air Missile
- (b) Air-to-Air Missile
- (c) Air-to-Surface Missile
- (d) Ballistic Missile

Answer: (c)

DRDO, IAF successfully flight-test indigenous RudraM-II air-to-surface missile

- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Air Force (IAF) have successfully conducted **flight-tests of the indigenous RudraM-II air-to-surface missile.**
- RudraM-II has been developed indigenously by Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad, the nodal DRDO laboratory in collaboration with several other DRDO establishments, including Defence Research and Development Laboratory (DRDL), High Energy Materials Research Laboratory (HEMRL), Armament Research & Development Establishment (ARDE), and ITR.



5. The Bamboo Research and Training Centre (BRTC), recently in the news, is located in which state?

बैबू रिसर्च एंड ट्रेनिंग सेंटर (BRTC), जो हाल ही में खबरों में था, किस राज्य में स्थित है?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh
- (b) Odisha
- (c) Chhattisgarh
- (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (d)

BRTC Chandrapur becomes first institute to get AICTE approval for Bamboo Technology diploma

- **The Bamboo Research and Training Centre – BRTC at Chichpalli in Maharashtra's Chandrapur district** has received approval from the All India Council for Technical Education – AICTE to launch a **three-year Diploma in Bamboo Technology from the 2026-27 academic year.**
- With this approval, **BRTC has become the first institution in India to secure AICTE recognition** for a standalone diploma programme in Bamboo Technology.
- The curriculum will cover bamboo processing and treatment technologies, furniture manufacturing, bamboo construction techniques, handicrafts, nursery management, product design, entrepreneurship development and industrial training.



6. Mission "Senehjori" focuses on the development of which of the following traditional silk varieties?

मिशन "सेनेहजोर" रेशम की निम्नलिखित में से किस पारंपरिक किस्म के विकास पर केंद्रित है?

- A) Tussar Silk
- B) Eri Silk
- C) Muga Silk
- D) Mulberry Silk

Answer: C

Mission Senehjori

- **Recently, the Union Minister for Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER) together with the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Assam launched Mission "Senehjori" – Assam Muga Silk USP.**
- It is a comprehensive **cluster-based initiative aimed at transforming Assam's unique Muga silk sector** into a globally competitive, high-value luxury textile ecosystem.
- **Objective:** It seeks to strengthen the entire Muga silk value chain from host-plant cultivation and silkworm seed production to reeling, weaving, branding, export promotion, digital traceability and tourism.
- **Funding:** It has an estimated investment of ₹396–411 crore over a **three-year period.**



7. Operation Chakravayuh, recently seen in the news, is associated with:

हाल ही में खबरों में रहा 'ऑपरेशन चक्रव्यूह' किससे संबंधित है?

- (a) Counter-terrorism operations
- (b) Anti-narcotics drive
- (c) Anti-piracy mission
- (d) Anti-smuggling of wildlife products

Answer: (b)

Operation Chakravayuh: DRI seizes 24 kg of narcotics in Kerala

- The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI), Kochi unit, has seized **24 kg of suspected narcotic drugs worth crores and arrested five persons as part of the intensified anti-narcotics drive in Kerala under Operation Chakravayuh.**
- The operation is part of sustained efforts to dismantle organised drug trafficking networks operating through international and domestic channels.

8. In which country did Storm Jangmi recently cause high waves, landslides, and flooding warnings?

हाल ही में किस देश में 'स्टॉर्म जांगमी' (Storm Jangmi) के कारण ऊंची लहरें उठीं, भूस्खलन हुआ और बाढ़ की चेतावनी जारी की गई?

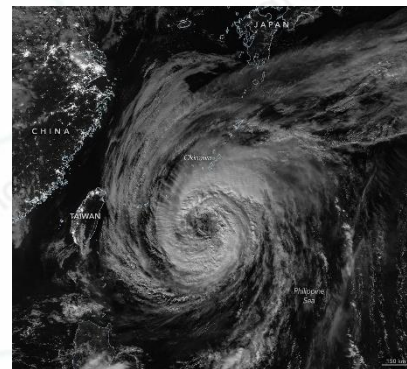
- (a) China
- (b) Philippines
- (c) Japan
- (d) South Korea

Answer: (c)



Tropical storm Jangmi injures 9 in Japan, thousands without power

- A severe tropical storm battered southwestern Japan
- The Japan Meteorological Agency warned of **high waves, landslides and flooding as storm Jangmi, which was downgraded from a typhoon, rumbles northwards after bearing down on the subtropical island of Okinawa**
- **A typhoon is a form of cyclone that has wind speeds of 119 kmph and above and develops over warm ocean waters near the equator.**
- When warm, moist air rises from the ocean surface, it creates a low-pressure area.

**Cyclones are rapid inward air circulation around a low-pressure area.**

- The air circulates in an **anticlockwise direction in the Northern hemisphere** and **clockwise in the Southern hemisphere.**

9. Odisha ranked first among states with a medium number of consumers in which of the following categories under the PM Surya Ghar Excellence Awards?

1. Highest number of consumer applications
2. Highest rooftop solar installations
3. Highest DISCOM inspections/verifications

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
 (b) 2 and 3 only
 (c) 1 and 3 only
 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

Odisha Selected for PM Surya Ghar Excellence Awards

- Odisha has **emerged as a national leader in solar energy adoption and sustainable development by securing the prestigious PM Surya Ghar Excellence Awards for its performance during the 'Month of Solar' campaign last month.**
- The Month of Solar campaign was held in May 2026.
- The **campaign included applications for solar systems, solar installations, and inspections by distribution companies, commonly called DISCOMs.**

Odisha 1st Position: Ranked first among states with a medium number of consumers across three distinct categories:

- Highest number of consumer applications.
- Highest rooftop solar installations.
- Highest DISCOM inspections/verifications.
- **3rd Position:** Earned third place in the "Maximum Vendor Registrations" category.
- **Chhattisgarh 2nd Position:** Secured second place nationally in the "Solar Campaign of the Month – Highest Vendor Registration" category

PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana is a central government scheme for rooftop solar power generation in India.

- The scheme aims to expand household-level solar adoption through installation-linked support and consumer participation.



10. The A2000, recently in the news, is:

A2000, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहा है, वह है:

- (a) A supercomputer developed by C-DAC
- (b) An AI system-on-chip developed by NetraSemi
- (c) A semiconductor fabrication plant
- (d) A quantum computing processor

Answer: (b)

Kerala startup unveils India's first AI system-on-chip

- Kerala-based fabless semiconductor **startup Netrasemi** launched its **flagship AI system-on-chip, the A2000**,
- **The A2000 is designed in India** and uses TSMC's 12 nm process node for edge devices such as smart cameras, edge AI boxes, and intelligent video gateways.

**11. Consider the following protected areas:**

Mhadei Wildlife Sanctuary
Cotigao Wildlife Sanctuary
Bhagwan Mahaveer Sanctuary
Netravali Wildlife Sanctuary

How many of the above is/are located in Goa?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

Answer: (d)

30 May Goa Statehood Day

- **Goa is the smallest state by area**, was a **Portuguese colony** for **over 450 years** until it was **liberated by India in 1961 by Operation Vijay** and was given the **status of union territory along with Daman and Diu**.
- On **30th May 1987** **Goa was granted statehood**, making it the **25th state of the Indian Union**.
- **Panaji** was designated as the **capital** of Goa, and **Konkani** was declared the **official language**.

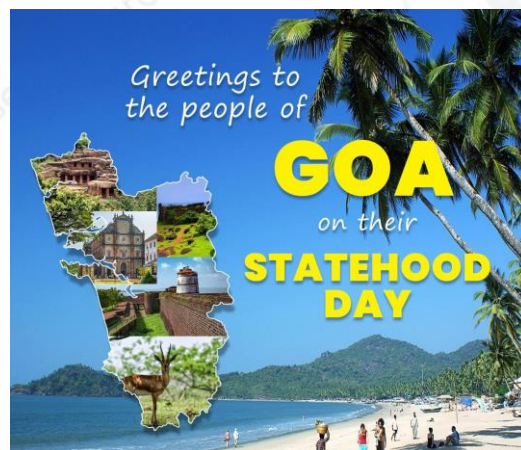
"Churches and Convents of Goa" recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1986

Borders:

- It is surrounded by **Maharashtra to the north and Karnataka to the east and south**, with the **Arabian Sea** forming its western coast.

Wildlife Sanctuaries and National Parks:

- Dr. Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary
- Bhagwan Mahaveer Sanctuary
- Mhadei Wildlife Sanctuary
- Netravali Wildlife Sanctuary
- Cotigao Wildlife Sanctuary
- Mollem National Park

12. A 'Blue Moon' is defined as:

'ब्लू मून' को इस प्रकार परिभाषित किया गया है:

- (a) A full moon that appears blue in colour
- (b) The first full moon of a calendar month
- (c) The second full moon occurring in a calendar month
- (d) A full moon occurring closest to Earth

Answer: (c)

Blue Micromoon

- Skywatchers will be treated to a rare sight this month: a Blue Moon that is also a "micromoon."

A blue moon is the second full moon in a calendar month.

- That is unusual because the period from one full moon to another is about 29 1/2 days.
- So **when two occur in the same month, the first of these full moons is always on the first or second day of the month.**
- On average, a blue moon occurs once every 33 months or full moons, 41 times per century, or about seven times every 19 years.
- **An even rarer event is when two blue moons happen in the same calendar year, which happens about four times per century.**
- Sometimes, smoke or dust in the air can scatter red wavelengths of light, as a result of which the moon may, in certain places, appear more blue than usual.
- **But this has nothing to do with the name "blue" moon, and the association of the colour with the term is unclear.**



What is a Micro Moon?

- This **refers to the apparent size of the moon as viewed from Earth.**
- The moon is not always a constant distance away from the Earth.
- Its **orbit around the Earth is elliptical.**
- **The moon is about 363,711 km away at its closest to earth, known as perigee.** At apogee, or the furthest point, the moon is about 403,945 km away.
- **If a full moon happens to occur close to its closest point, then we call that a supermoon.** And if it's close to its furthest point, then we call that a micromoon.
- A micromoon appears only about 14% smaller than a supermoon and about 6% smaller than a typical full moon.

How Rare is a Blue Micromoon?

- Blue moons occur every couple of years, and micromoons occur two or three times every year.
- A **blue micromoon occurs about once every couple of decades.**
- However, they aren't regular, and two such events may occur closer together or further apart.
- **No special equipment is needed to observe this blue micromoon, and it should be clearly visible in the absence of clouds.**



13. Consider the following statements regarding the PM SVANidhi Scheme:

1. The scheme is implemented exclusively by the Ministry of Rural Development.
2. Vendors who successfully repay the second loan tranche become eligible for a UPI-linked RuPay Credit Card with an operating limit of up to ₹30,000.
3. The first loan tranche under the scheme is ₹15,000.

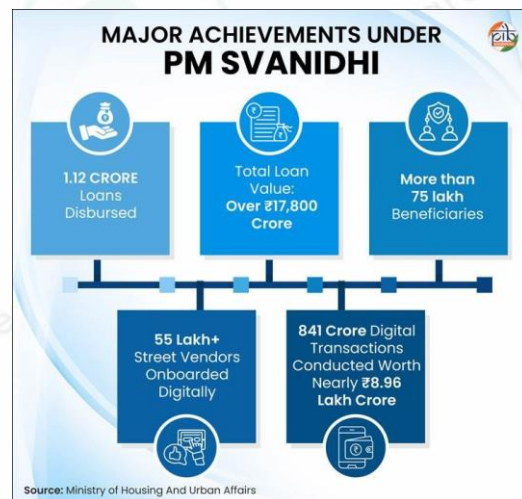
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
 (b) 1 and 2 only
 (c) 3 only
 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

PM SVANidhi scheme completes six years of implementation

- **The Prime Minister Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) scheme has completed six years of public implementation since its initial launch in June 2020**
- **PM SVANidhi is a pioneering, central sector micro-credit flagship scheme launched during the COVID-19 pandemic to assist urban street vendors and hawkers.**
- **Managed as a joint administrative responsibility of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) and the Department of Financial Services (DFS), the scheme provides formal, collateral-free working capital loans to support business recovery, grassroots digital onboarding, and comprehensive social security protection.**



Key Features of PM SVANidhi:

- **Progressive Collateral-Free Loans:** Provides credit in three separate tranches of ₹15,000, ₹25,000, and ₹50,000. Successive higher limits are unlocked automatically upon the timely repayment of previous loans.
- **Incentivizes timely or early loan repayments by offering an interest subsidy of 7 percent per annum, which is credited directly to the vendor's account.**
- **Vendors who successfully repay their second tranche become eligible for special UPI-linked RuPay Credit Cards with an operating limit of up to ₹30,000.**
- **Offers an annual digital cashback incentive of up to ₹1,600 to reward and encourage retail or wholesale transactions through digital payment gateways.**
- **SVANidhi se Samridhi (SSS):** Conducts detailed socio-economic profiling of vendors and their families to seamlessly link them with eight selected Central Government welfare schemes, creating an institutional safety net.
- **FSSAI Food Safety Training:** Collaborates directly with the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) to provide specialized capacity building in local financial literacy, digital workflows, and hygiene standards.

14. Divyastra Mk-1, recently demonstrated by the Indian Army, is best described as a:

भारतीय सेना द्वारा हाल ही में प्रदर्शित 'दिव्यास्त्र Mk-1' को सबसे बेहतर ढंग से इस रूप में वर्णित किया जा सकता है:

- (a) Surface-to-air missile system
 (b) Tactical loitering munition
 (c) Main battle tank
 (d) Anti-submarine drone

Answer: (b)

Indian Army Tests Divyastra Mk-1 Loitering Munition

- The Indian Army conducted an operational demonstration of the indigenous Divyastra Mk-1 tactical loitering munition in Jodhpur on 1 June 2026.
- The **system is developed by Hoverit, a Lucknow-based defence technology startup**, and it has a reported 95% indigenous component rate.
- The **Divyastra Mk-1 is an AI-powered tactical unmanned aerial vehicle used for intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance, and precision strike missions.**
- It has an operational range of up to 500 km, an endurance of up to 5 hours, an attack speed of 300–400 km/h, and a payload capacity of 15 kg.

Loitering munitions are also called suicide drones or kamikaze drones in military terminology.

- The system was launched multiple times from a vehicle-mounted mobile launcher during the demonstration.
- It was validated for dynamic intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance missions under field conditions in desert temperatures exceeding 50°C.



15. Recently discovered Indopottia himalayensis belongs to which of the following groups?

हाल ही में खोजा गया Indopottia himalayensis निम्नलिखित में से किस समूह से संबंधित है?

- (a) Fern
- (b) Moss
- (c) Lichen
- (d) Algae

Answer: (b)

Indopottia Himalayensis

- **Recently, scientists from the Botanical Survey of India have discovered a new species of moss and named it as Indopottia himalayensis.**
- It is a new moss species discovered from high-altitude forests of the Western Himalayas in **Uttarakhand state.**
- It is **only the third species of its kind ever identified globally.**
- Other two species reside far away in the Western Ghats of southern India and the mountains of Thailand.
- The research team chose the name Indopottia himalayensis as a tribute to the magnificent Himalayan mountain range.

Key Facts about Moss

- It is a small **nonvascular** spore-bearing land plant belonging to the taxonomic division Bryophyta.
- It is **among the earliest land plants and has colonised some of the harshest environments on the planet, including Antarctica, volcanic fields, and deserts.**
- **There are three main types:** peat moss, granite moss and true moss.

Mosses are distributed throughout the world except in salt water.

- It is the small plant commonly found in damp, shady spots is already known for its resilience on Earth.



16. Which of the following sectors are proposed to be covered under the Services Producer Price Index (SPPI)?

1. Transport
2. Insurance
3. Pension Fund Management
4. Telecom Services

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
 (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
 (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (d)

New WPI series out on June 15, but to be replaced by Producer Price Index in 2031

- The Ministry of Commerce will release a new Wholesale Price Index (WPI) series with 2022–23 as the base year on June 15.
- However, this new year series will in all likelihood be discontinued after five years in 2031 and the Producer Price Index (PPI) based on output prices will become the main measure of non-retail inflation.
- What is Producer Price Index (PPI)?
- PPI measures changes in prices received by producers for goods and services before they reach consumers.
- Unlike WPI, which mainly tracks goods, PPI covers both goods and services.
- It includes prices at different stages of production and distribution, making it a more comprehensive indicator of inflation.

	WPI-2011/12 series		WPI-2022/23 series	
	No. of items	Weight	No. of items	Weight
Primary Articles items	115	22.62%	129	22.76%
Fuel & Power items	18	13.15%	25	14.11%
Manufactured items	564	64.23%	803	63.13%
TOTAL ITEMS	697	100%	957	100%

Source: Ministry of Commerce & Industry • Get the data • Created with Datawrapper

Services Producer Price Index (SPPI)

- India will also release a Services Producer Price Index (SPPI) covering sectors such as:
- Transport
- Insurance
- Passenger transport
- Pension fund management
- Telecom services
- SPPI will be published on a quarterly basis, with the first data set covering January–March 2025.
- Like the new WPI and PPI series, SPPI will also use 2022–23 as the base year.

Why is India Moving Towards PPI?

- Economists and institutions such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) have long recommended adopting PPI.

PPI is considered more aligned with modern economic structures and international practices.

- It helps estimate real GDP more accurately and provides a better measure of producer-side inflation.
- International organisations such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) have recommended adopting PPI as a modern inflation indicator.

Key Changes in the New Series

- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) has updated the base years for both CPI and GDP, while also improving calculation methods.

Along with the new WPI, the government will introduce:

- Monthly Output PPI
- Monthly Input PPI
- Monthly Manufacturing PPI
- Initially, the Input PPI will be released for experimental purposes and refined after feedback from users and stakeholders.

17. The ToFEI application recently launched by the Government of India is:

भारत सरकार द्वारा हाल ही में लॉन्च किया गया ToFEI एप्लिकेशन है:

- (a) A digital platform for monitoring tobacco-free guidelines in educational institutions
- (b) An online portal for tobacco product licensing
- (c) A mobile application for tobacco farmers
- (d) A platform for tobacco taxation management

Answer: (a)

Govt launches App to monitor implementation of tobacco-free norms

- Ahead of World No Tobacco Day 2026, **Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava launched the pilot version of the Tobacco-Free Educational Institutions (ToFEI) Application and released a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for tobacco product sample collection, reinforcing the Centre's efforts to combat tobacco and nicotine addiction among youth.**
- The ToFEI application is a digital platform aimed at strengthening the implementation and monitoring of tobacco-free guidelines across schools and colleges.
- The app is designed to facilitate self-assessment and reporting by educational institutions, monitor compliance with tobacco-control norms, **enforce signage requirements, prohibit the sale of tobacco products within 100 yards of educational institutions and promote awareness activities among students and teachers.**
- The **pilot project will initially be implemented in Rajasthan, Meghalaya and Maharashtra** to assess operational feasibility and strengthen reporting and monitoring systems before a nationwide rollout.

18. Which state became the first to operationalise an industry partnership under the PM-SETU scheme?

PM-SETU योजना के तहत इंडस्ट्री पार्टनरशिप को लागू करने वाला पहला राज्य कौन-सा बना?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (d)

Arcelor Mittal Nippon Steel India Secures First-Ever Strategic Investment Plan Approval under PM-SETU

- The **National Steering Committee (NSC) has approved the strategic investment plan for the Visakhapatnam ITI Cluster in Andhra Pradesh submitted by ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India under the Rs 60,000 crore PM-SETU scheme.**
- The approval marks the first-ever Strategic Investment Plan to be cleared **under Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) and makes Andhra Pradesh the first state to operationalise an industry partnership under the scheme.**



About PM-SETU

- **Type:** centrally sponsored scheme.
- **Aim:** To transform 1,000 Government Industrial Training Institutes (it is) across India into modern, industry-aligned training institutions.
- **Implementation:** PM-SETU will follow a hub-and-spoke model, with 200 hub ITIs linked to 800 spoke ITIs.
- Each hub will be equipped with advanced infrastructure, innovation and incubation centres, production units, training of trainer facilities, and placement services, while the spokes will extend access and outreach.

About ITIs(Industrial Training Institute)

- **Structure:** Operating under state governments, ITIs have been backbone of Vocational Education and Training (VET) in India since the 1950s.
- **ITIs' Accreditation:** Entrusted to the DGT, apex organization of VET (Vocational Education and Training) under Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship.

19. Raipur has recently emerged as a national model for urban water conservation under which initiative?

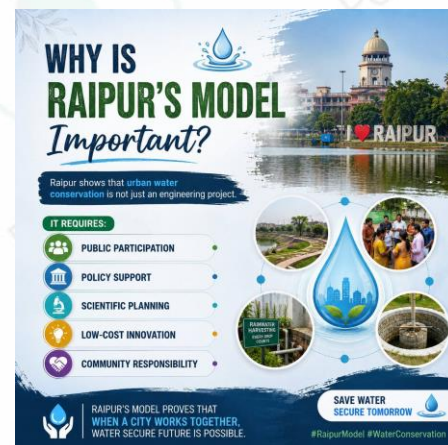
हाल ही में रायपुर किस पहल के तहत शहरी जल संरक्षण के लिए एक राष्ट्रीय मॉडल के रूप में उभरा है?

- (a) Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari
(b) Atal Bhujal Yojana
(c) Jal Jeevan Mission
(d) AMRUT 2.0

Answer: (a)

Raipur's Rainwater Revolution

- **Raipur has emerged as a national model for urban water conservation under the Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari (JSJB) initiative**, creating nearly 32,000 rainwater harvesting and groundwater recharge structures.
- **Aim:** To improve groundwater recharge and reduce urban water stress caused by rapid urbanisation and excessive groundwater extraction.
- To transform Raipur into a climate-resilient Sponge City capable of conserving and reusing rainwater efficiently.
- Includes pond interlinking, Kharun River Eco Bloc projects, and treated wastewater reuse for industrial purposes.

**20. Under the revised rules, foreigners on a visa of 180 days or less who wish to stay beyond the visa period must register:**

संशोधित नियमों के तहत, 180 दिन या उससे कम अवधि के वीज़ा पर आए वे विदेशी नागरिक, जो वीज़ा अवधि समाप्त होने के बाद भी रुकना चाहते हैं, उन्हें पंजीकरण कराना होगा:

- (a) Within 14 days after expiry of the visa
(b) Within 30 days after arrival in India
(c) Any time before the expiry of the 180-day period
(d) Only after obtaining an extension

Answer: (c)

New visa rules require foreigners to register before 180-day limit in India

- The **foreigners coming to India on a visa for 180 days or less will now have to register themselves "any time before the expiry of the said period of 180 days"** in case they want to stay beyond the visa period, according to changes in the Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025.
- The new provision, notified, will replace the previous rule **that required the registration "within fourteen days after the expiry of one hundred and eighty days of arrival in India."**
- Previous rules stipulated that upon the birth of the child in such cases, parents had to electronically intimate the registration officer within 30 days for availing visa services, including the grant of new visa and exit permission on the designated online portal or the mobile application.
- According to the notification, this sub-rule shall not apply in cases wherein either of the parents is an Indian citizen and such parent wishes to retain the Indian citizenship of the child.
- It, however, says that if the child acquires citizenship of a foreign country while in India at a later stage, either of the parents shall intimate the position to the registration officer within thirty days of acquiring the citizenship of the foreign country by the child.



21. The giant coral colony of Pavona clavus, recently documented by researchers, was discovered near which island of Lakshadweep?

शोधकर्ताओं द्वारा हाल ही में प्रलेखित पावना क्लैवस की विशाल प्रवाल कॉलोनी, लक्षद्वीप के किस द्वीप के निकट खोजी गई थी?

- (a) Kadmat Island
- (b) Agatti Island
- (c) Minicoy Island
- (d) Kavaratti Island

Answer: (a)

Lakshadweep Potato Patch Coral Colony Identified

- Researchers in India have **documented a giant coral colony near Kadmat Island in Lakshadweep, spread across an estimated 4,250 sq m.**
- The Pavona clavus formation, known locally as the **"Potato Patch"**.
- The colony may also represent a long-lived coral structure around 700 to 1,800 years old,
- Lakshadweep is an Indian Union Territory in the Arabian Sea and contains coral atolls, reefs and lagoons.



Coral reefs are vibrant underwater ecosystems built by reef-forming corals.

- These corals are **marine invertebrates** that share a symbiotic relationship with algae known as **zooxanthellae**.
- These corals secrete calcium carbonate (limestone) exoskeletons, which over time accumulate to form the massive, colorful, and biologically rich reefs.
- **Coral reefs require precise environmental conditions to flourish, including warm water temperatures between 23°C and 29°C, shallow depths for sunlight penetration, and stable salinity levels.**
- **Coral reefs are classified into four types based on structure and location:** Fringing Reefs, Barrier Reefs, Atolls, and Patch Reefs

22. Who recently assumed charge as the 48th Vice Chief of the Naval Staff?

हाल ही में नौसेना स्टाफ के 48वें उप-प्रमुख के रूप में किसने कार्यभार संभाला है?

- (a) Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar
- (b) Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan
- (c) Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi
- (d) Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan

Answer: (a)

Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar Becomes 48th Vice Chief of Naval Staff

- **Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar**, who spearheaded high-level naval combat readiness during Operation Sindoor, assumed charge as the 48th Vice Chief of the Naval Staff.
- Vice Admiral Kochhar **was commissioned into the Indian Navy on July 1, 1988.**
- He took charge as Chief of Staff, Western Naval Command on May 25, 2024,
- **His command assignments include INS Nashak, INS Vibhuti, INS Kirpan, frigate INS Trikand, and aircraft carrier INS Vikramaditya.**
- The Flag Officer has also served as Commander, Western Fleet, Commandant of the National Defence Academy, and Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman and Nicobar Command
- For his exemplary leadership and distinguished service, **he was awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2022 and the Param Vishisht Seva Medal in 2026.**

**23. Match List I (IPL 2026 Award) with List II (Winner) and select the correct answer using the code given below:**

List I (Award)	List II (Winner)
A. Most Valuable Player	1. Punjab Kings
B. Emerging Player	2. Manish Pandey
C. Best Catch	3. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi
D. Fair Play Award	4. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi

Code:

- (a) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
- (b) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
- (c) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
- (d) A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3

Answer: (a)

Royal Challengers Bengaluru win IPL 2026 title

- **Royal Challengers Bengaluru became only the third team in history to successfully defend the Indian Premier League title as they beat Gujarat Titans by five wickets in the IPL 2026 final at the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad.**
- Royal Challengers Bengaluru clinched its **second consecutive IPL title**
- **Only two teams** - MS Dhoni's Chennai Super Kings (2010 and 2011) and Rohit Sharma's Mumbai Indians (2019 and 2020) - had successfully defended the IPL title before this.



- **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who won five awards** -- Emerging Player, Most Valuable Player, Orange Cap, and the awards for the best strike rate and most sixes.

IPL 2026 Prize Winners

- **Orange Cap:** Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR) - 776 runs
- **Purple Cap:** Kagiso Rabada (GT) - 29 wickets
- **Most Valuable Player:** Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR)
- **Emerging Player:** Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR)
- **Most sixes:** Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR) - 71 sixes
- **Most fours:** Sai Sudharsan (GT) - 75 fours
- **Best strike rate:** Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR) - 237.31
- **Most dot balls:** Mohammed Siraj (GT) - 172 dot balls
- **Best catch:** Manish Pandey (KKR)
- **Fair Play Award:** Punjab Kings
- **Pitch and Grounds Award (Four matches or less):** Himachal Pradesh Cricket Association
- **Pitch and Grounds Award:** Cricket Association of Bengal

24. 'Samadhan Didi', recently launched by the Government of India, is primarily associated with:
भारत सरकार द्वारा हाल ही में शुरू की गई 'समाधान दीदी' मुख्य रूप से किससे संबंधित है?

- (a) Digital payments
- (b) Healthcare consultations
- (c) Public grievance redressal
- (d) Online education

Answer: (c)

Union Minister Jitendra Singh Launches AI-Enabled CPGRAMS Voice Chatbot 'SAMADHAN DIDI'

- In a first-of-its-kind initiative, the **Government of India launched "Samadhan Didi", an AI enabled, voice first chatbot for the Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS), enabling citizens to register grievances simply by speaking in their preferred language.**
- The chatbot is designed to help citizens lodge grievances with ease, particularly those who are unsure where to submit a complaint or whom to address it to, and those who are unable to draft complaints in Hindi or English.

Developed by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances in collaboration with Bhashini.

- With Samadhan Didi, citizens can register grievances by describing their concerns in plain, everyday language.
- There is **no requirement to identify the relevant ministry, department, category or sub category.**
- The system combines Bhashini's language processing capabilities with grievance classification models trained on CPGRAMS data, enabling efficient and accurate grievance handling across multiple Indian languages.



25. Salaya Port, recently seen in the news, is situated in the:

सलाया बंदरगाह, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहा है, स्थित है:

- (a) Gulf of Mannar
- (b) Gulf of Khambhat
- (c) Gulf of Kutch
- (d) Palk Strait

Answer: c

The Salaya Port

- Due to the escalation of the Middle East conflict and the approach of the rough monsoon season, the **Union Government temporarily designated Porbandar as an Immigration Check Post (ICP) for the non-notified ports of Salaya and Okha.**
- Salaya is a historic, traditional minor tidal port heavily celebrated as the primary hub for India's traditional dhow and mechanised sailing vessel (MSV) trade.
- **It serves as a vital logistics base for small-scale, export-oriented merchant commerce connecting the Indian western seaboard with West Asia and East Africa.**
- **Location:** Situated inside the well-sheltered, natural contours of the Gulf of Kutch.
- **Administrative District:** Located in the Devbhoomi Dwarka district of Gujarat, India.
- **Okha Port is an all-weather, non-major commercial and fishing seaport located on the northwestern tip of the Saurashtra peninsula in Gujarat, India.**

**26. With reference to Isobutanol, recently seen in the news, consider the following statements:**

It is completely soluble in water.

Its vapours are heavier than air.

It is highly flammable.

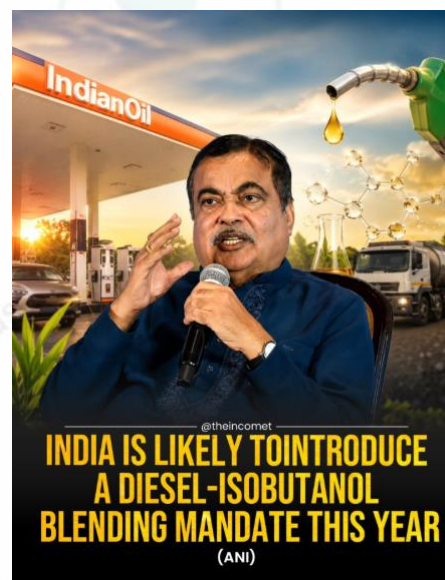
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: b

Isobutanol

- The Indian government is likely to **introduce a mandate permitting blending isobutanol with diesel by the end of this year.**
- It is also called isobutyl alcohol, is an alcohol with the chemical formula $C_4H_{10}O$ and one of the four isomers of butanol
- It is a **clear, colorless liquid with a characteristic odor.**
- It is only moderately soluble in water.
- It is **very flammable and has a flash point that is only slightly above normal room temperatures.**
- Its vapors are heavier than air and can spread unnoticed along the ground.
- It can **be made from ethanol using fermentation processes.**



Applications of Isobutanol

- It is **used as a solvent in the flavor, fragrance, pharmaceutical, and pesticide industries and as a chemical manufacturing ingredient for products such as lacquer, paint strippers, paint primer, and craft paints.**
- It is an approved food additive and is also naturally occurring in some foods and many alcoholic beverages.
- Isobutanol may also be used as a biofuel because, **like ethanol, it can be manufactured from plants.**

27. The 'Nirbhay Raho' Initiative has been launched by the:

‘निर्भय रहो’ पहल किसके द्वारा शुरू की गई है?

- (a) Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- (b) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (c) Ministry of Women and Child Development
- (d) Ministry of Rural Development

Answer: (a)

Nirbhay Raho Initiative

- **The Ministry of Panchayati Raj successfully conducted a three-day national Training of Trainers (ToT) program in New Delhi.**
- The program **focused on legal provisions for women's security, marking a major step forward for the Ministry's newly launched 'Nirbhay Raho' initiative.**
- The 'Nirbhay Raho' Initiative is a national **gender-responsive governance** and grassroots capacity-building program.
- It is structurally funded and **implemented through the Union Government's non-lapsable Nirbhaya Fund**, transforming local self-governments into active protective anchors for women.
- **Nodal Ministry:** Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Government of India.

28. Who among the following was appointed as a Judge of the Supreme Court in the recent expansion of the apex court?

1. Justice Sheel Nagu
2. Justice Shree Chandrashekhar
3. Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva
4. Justice Arun Palli
5. Venkita Subramani Mohana

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only
- (b) 1, 2, 4 and 5 only
- (c) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
- (d) 2, 3 and 5 only

Answer: (c)

Supreme Court gets 5 new judges; strength to go up to 37

- Five new Judges were appointed to the Supreme Court, **which will now have 37 judges, one short of the upgraded sanctioned strength of 38.**
- Once they take oath and assume charge, the Supreme Court will formally have 37 judges.



- The Government last month promulgated an ordinance amending a law to increase the sanctioned strength of the apex court to 38 from 34, including the Chief Justice of India.

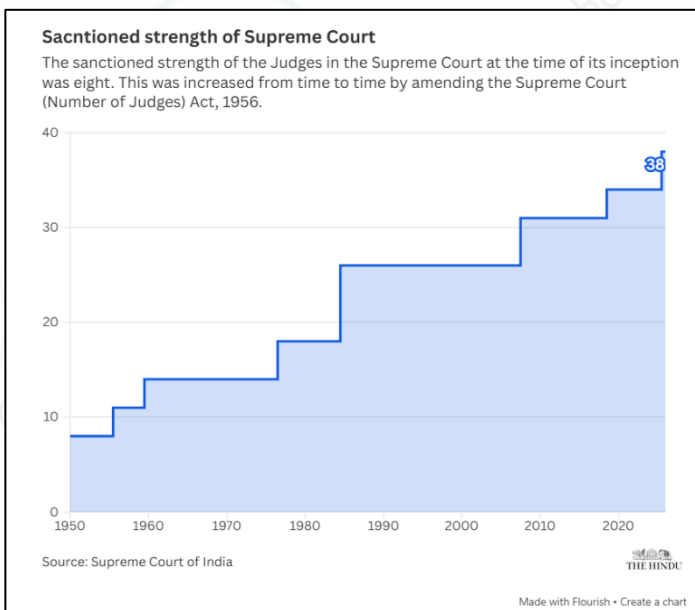
Chief Justice Surya Kant

The appointees are:

- Justice Sheel Nagu, Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana high court**
- Justice Shree Chandrashekhar, Chief Justice of the Bombay high court
- Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva, Chief Justice of the Madhya Pradesh high court

Justice Arun Palli, Chief Justice of the high court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh

- Senior advocate Venkita Subramani Mohana



29. According to the Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI) 2024-25, which port led the Liquid Bulk segment?

लॉजिस्टिक्स पोर्ट परफॉर्मेंस इंडेक्स (LPPI) 2024-25 के अनुसार, लिक्विड बल्क सेगमेंट में किस पोर्ट ने सबसे अच्छा प्रदर्शन किया?

- Paradip Port Authority (Odisha)
- Cochin Port Authority (Kerala)
- Sikka Port and Terminals (Gujarat)
- Deendayal Port Authority (Gujarat)

Answer: (c)

Logistics Port Performance Index

- Recently, the **Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW)** launched the logistics port performance index (LPPI) for FY2024- 25 and 4 major digital initiatives.
- It is developed under the Sagar Aankalan framework.
- It is a national benchmarking mechanism designed to assess and improve the operational performance of Indian ports.
- India's ranking in the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index improved from 44th to 22nd position in the International Shipments category**, while seven Indian ports featured among the world's top 100 ports in the World Bank's Container Port Performance Index 2024.
- The **ministry also brought in four digital modules developed by the Directorate General of Shipping (DGS)**, including a 24x7 grievance redressal system under the e-Navik platform, a ship registration module on e-Samudra, a medical practitioner module and a unified ship recycling credit note module.
- The **LPPI evaluates ports across three cargo segments dry bulk, liquid bulk and container cargo using operational indicators such as;**
 - Cargo handled, vessel turnaround time, berth idle time, pre-berthing waiting time, container dwell time and ship berth day output.
- The index aligns with the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan, Maritime India Vision 2030 and Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047**, and seeks to strengthen India's position in global logistics and maritime trade.



Top Performers:

- **Paradip Port Authority (Odisha)** topped the Dry Bulk category.
- **Sikka Port and Terminals (Gujarat)** led the Liquid Bulk segment.
- **Mundra Port (Gujarat)** emerged as the highest-ranked port in Container Cargo (with **Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) (Maharashtra)** securing the second position).

30. The Earth Prize 2026 was awarded to a group of Indian students for developing a solution to address which environmental problem?

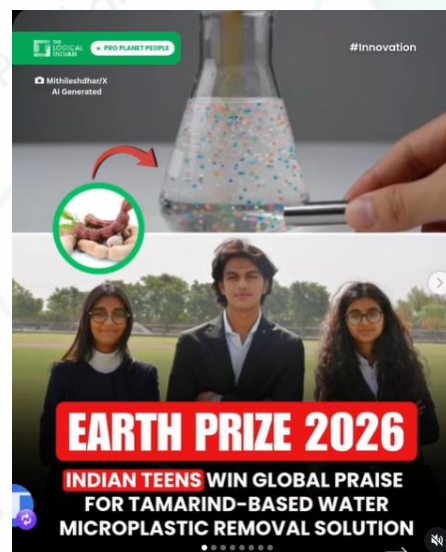
द अर्थ प्राइज़ 2026 भारतीय छात्रों के एक समूह को किस पर्यावरण समस्या को हल करने के लिए समाधान विकसित करने हेतु प्रदान किया गया था?

- (a) Air pollution
- (b) E-waste management
- (c) Microplastic contamination in water
- (d) Soil salinization

Answer: (c)

Indian Teenagers Win Earth Prize 2026 for Plas-Stick

- A group of Indian students, Vivaan Chhawchharia, Ariana Agarwal and Avyana Mehta, has won The Earth Prize 2026 for developing a low-cost method to pull microplastics out of water.
- The Earth Prize is an international environmental competition for young innovators.
- The teens **designed a biodegradable material derived from tamarind seed powder that can bind to tiny plastic particles in contaminated water.**
- The innovation, known as Plas-Stick, showed promise for trapping microplastics that conventional filters often miss, without adding harmful chemicals to the water.
- The collected plastic is safely turned into small useful items like tiles or coasters so it can't return to nature.

**31. According to the State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026 Report, India ranks ____ among the world's most digitalized economies.**

. 'स्टेट ऑफ़ इंडियाज़ डिजिटल इकोनॉमी (SIDE) 2026' रिपोर्ट के अनुसार, दुनिया की सबसे ज़्यादा डिजिटलाइज़्ड अर्थव्यवस्थाओं में भारत का स्थान ____ है।

- (a) Third
- (b) Fourth
- (c) Fifth
- (d) Sixth

Answer: (c)

India Ranks 4th in AI Performance, 5th in Digital Economy

- India has emerged as the world's fifth most digitalized economy and ranks fourth globally in AI performance, **as reported by the ICRIR-Prosus Centre for Internet and Digital Economy (IPCIDE).**
- **India surpasses Germany, France, Japan, the UK, and Canada in the AI race** with 72% of global AI users now found in developing countries.



- The **State of India's Digital Economy (SIDE) 2026** report ranks **India fifth on the CHIPS-AI index**.
- India's digital momentum has accelerated, propelling it to fifth in global rankings, previously eighth in 2025.

32. The Centre appointed IAS officer _____ as the new Chairperson of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE).

केंद्र सरकार ने IAS अधिकारी _____ को सेंट्रल बोर्ड ऑफ़ सेकेंडरी एजुकेशन (CBSE) का नया चेयरपर्सन नियुक्त किया।

- (a) Rahul Singh
- (b) Varun Bhardwaj
- (c) Himanshu Gupta
- (d) Prashant Sitaram Lokhande

Answer: (d)

Centre names Lokhande Sitaram as CBSE chairperson, Varun Bhardwaj secretary

- The Centre appointed **senior IAS officer Prashant Sitaram Lokhande** as the new chairperson of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) **replacing Rahul Singh**, who has been transferred to the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare as Additional Secretary.
- Named Varun Bhardwaj as the board's new Secretary, Bhardwaj succeeds Himanshu Gupta, He will serve in the position until September 19, 2027



33. Which country remained the leading importer of Indian seafood in terms of value during 2025-26?

2025-26 के दौरान, मूल्य के आधार पर भारतीय समुद्री भोजन का सबसे बड़ा आयातक देश कौन सा रहा?

- (a) Japan
- (b) China
- (c) Vietnam
- (d) United States

Answer: (d)

India's seafood exports hit record \$8.46 billion in 2025-26: MPEDA

- India exported a record 19,72,018 metric tonnes (MT) of seafood valued at ₹73,890.46 crore (\$8.46 billion) in fiscal year 2025-26.

The figures mark an all-time high in terms of volume and value despite global challenges

- Chairman of the Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) - P. Jawahar
- The **United States and China remained the primary importers of Indian seafood**,
- The **frozen shrimp remained the leading product in seafood exports, accounted for 40.19% of the total quantity**
- Frozen fish, the second-largest exported item, generated
- In terms of overseas markets, the U.S. remained the leading importer of Indian seafood,
- China emerged as the largest destination for Indian seafood exports in terms of quantity
- Vizag, JNPT and Kochi were the top three ports handling seafood cargo.

India's seafood exports hit record \$8.46 bn in FY26 amid global headwinds

BUSINESS STANDARD JUNE 2ND, 2026



Overcoming global market uncertainties, India's seafood exports touched an all-time high in both volume and value as the country shipped nearly two million tonnes of seafood during 2025-26. India exported 19.72 lakh tonnes of seafood worth \$8.46 billion in

34. Beaufort Castle, recently seen in the news, is located in:

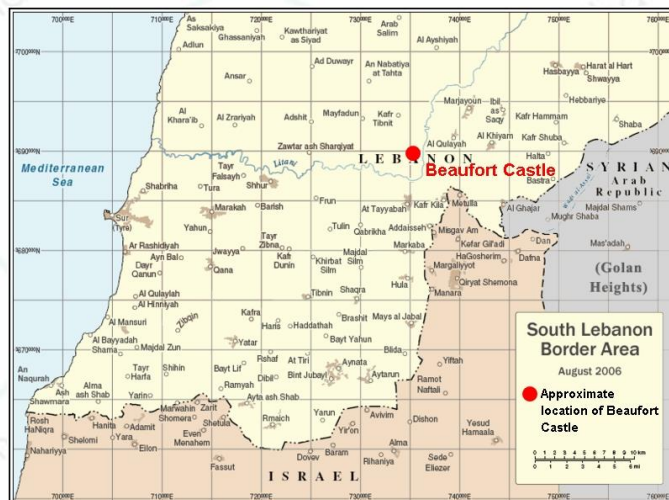
हाल ही में खबरों में रहा ब्यूफोर्ट कैसल यहाँ स्थित है:

- (a) Syria
- (b) Jordan
- (c) Lebanon
- (d) Israel

Answer: (c)

Beaufort Castle

- Amid the West Asia conflict, Israel has pushed itself deeper into Lebanon recently, capturing the historic Beaufort Castle and the surrounding strategic ridge.
- Beaufort Castle — known locally as Qalaat al-Shaqif or the “Castle of the High Rock”, is a medieval fortress situated atop a commanding hill near the city of Nabatieh in southern Lebanon.
- It is located just 14.5 km from the Israeli border.
- Originally built by Crusaders in the 12th century, the castle has changed hands multiple times throughout history, passing through Crusader, Muslim, Mamluk, and Ottoman control.
- It overlooks vast stretches of southern Lebanon, the Litani River valley, and parts of northern Israel, making it a position of considerable strategic value.
- In 1982, amid the Lebanon War, Israel captured Beaufort Castle from the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) and held it until it withdrew from Lebanon in 2000



35. Khalilur Rahman, recently elected President of the 81st Session of the UNGA, belongs to:

हाल ही में UNGA के 81वें सत्र के अध्यक्ष चुने गए खलीलुर रहमान का संबंध है:

- (a) Cyprus
- (b) Bangladesh
- (c) Sri Lanka
- (d) Malaysia

Answer: (b)

Bangladesh Elected to Lead 81st UN General Assembly Session

Bangladeshi Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman was elected President of the UN General Assembly's 81st session

- A total of 190 ballots were cast, with no invalid votes or abstentions.
- The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA), established in 1945, is the primary policy-making body of the UN with equal representation for all states. It meets annually to address global issues such as peace, climate change, and human rights.
- Formed after the League of Nations' failure.
- The structure of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) consists of all 193 UN Member States, each holding one vote



- **Presidency:** The presidency rotates annually among five geographic groups- African, Asian, Eastern European, Latin American and Caribbean, Western European and others.

36. Fazil Nagar Assembly constituency, recently renamed as Pawagarh, is located in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

फ़ाज़िल नगर विधानसभा क्षेत्र, जिसका नाम हाल ही में बदलकर पावागढ़ कर दिया गया है, उत्तर प्रदेश के किस ज़िले में स्थित है?

- (a) Kushinagar
- (b) Deoria
- (c) Gorakhpur
- (d) Maharajganj

Answer: (a)

Fazil Nagar in UP renamed Pawagarh: CM Yogi Adityanath

- Fazil Nagar assembly segment in Kushinagar district of eastern UP will now be known as **Pawagarh in honour of Jain Tirthankar Lord Mahavir.**
- The proposed name, Pawagarh, is **derived from Pawapuri in Bihar, a revered Jain pilgrimage site which is believed to be the Nirvana site of Lord Mahavir.**

A SIGNIFICANT MOVE BY THE YOGI GOVERNMENT! FAZILNAGAR WILL NOW BE KNOWN AS PAVA NAGARI.



CHIEF MINISTER YOGI ADITYANATH HAS MADE THIS KEY ANNOUNCEMENT, STATING THAT FAZILNAGAR IN KUSHINAGAR DISTRICT WILL OFFICIALLY BE RENAMED 'PAVA NAGARI'. THIS STEP HAS BEEN TAKEN IN VIEW OF THE RELIGIOUS AND HISTORICAL IMPORTANCE OF THE REGION LINKED TO LORD MAHAVIRA'S LIFE. WHAT IS YOUR OPINION ON THIS, TELL US BY COMMENTING.

37. The Food Planet Prize 2026, worth \$1.5 million, was awarded to which Indian initiative?

\$1.5 मिलियन मूल्य का फूड प्लैनेट पुरस्कार 2026 किस भारतीय पहल को प्रदान किया गया?

- (a) Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana
- (b) Zero Budget Natural Farming Mission
- (c) National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture
- (d) Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF)

Answer: (D)

Andhra Pradesh CNF wins \$1.5-million Food Planet Prize 2026 in Sweden for natural farming push

- The **Andhra Pradesh Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF) programme, implemented by Rythu Sadhikara Samstha**, has won the Food Planet Prize 2026, worth \$1.5 million, **for leading one of the world's largest transitions to natural farming.**
- The award was presented in Bastad, Sweden.
- **The prize, given by the Curt Bergfors Foundation, recognises initiatives that could contribute to resilient, equitable and environmentally sustainable food systems within the next decade.**
- The other finalists, Conscious Kitchen of the United States, NoPalm Ingredients of the Netherlands and the Savanna Institute of the United States, each received \$150,000.
- **APCNF** - Launched in 2016 by the government of Andhra Pradesh, APCNF is one of the world's largest community-led transitions to agroecology and natural farming.
- The model is being replicated in 21 States and in countries such as Sri Lanka, Indonesia and Zambia.



38. India's first 'SkyCast' System was recently inaugurated at:

भारत के पहले 'SkyCast' सिस्टम का हाल ही में यहाँ उद्घाटन किया गया:

- (a) Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai
- (b) Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru
- (c) Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi
- (d) Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, Hyderabad

Answer: (c)

India's First SkyCast System

- Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated **India's first 'SkyCast' System at Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGI), New Delhi.**
- SkyCast is a **next-generation, integrated atmospheric remote sensing system designed for aviation weather monitoring.**
- It brings **together multiple real-time measurements of fog, aerosols, turbulence, moisture, and visibility into a single, comprehensive aviation weather intelligence framework.**
- **Developed By:** The system was developed under the Government of India's Mission Mausam initiative by the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES).
- The **primary objective of SkyCast is to usher India into an era of fog-free, weather-smart aviation.**
- It aims to dramatically reduce flight delays, cancellations, and diversions caused by adverse weather conditions while maximizing safety during critical take-off and landing phases.
- **Combines state-of-the-art instruments including a Radar Wind Profiler, SODAR, Microwave Radiometer, Ground-based Fog Aerosol Spectrometer (GFAS), and a CL61 Lidar-based Ceilometer.**
- The system continuously monitors and maps boundary-layer dynamics, wind speed, wind direction, vertical velocity, and turbulence up to an altitude of nearly 3 km.



39. India's medal tally at the Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026 consisted of:

एशियाई U20 एथलेटिक्स चैंपियनशिप 2026 में भारत की पदक तालिका में शामिल थे:

- (a) 10 Gold, 5 Silver and 4 Bronze medals
- (b) 14 Gold, 6 Silver and 5 Bronze medals
- (c) 10 Gold, 4 Silver and 5 Bronze medals
- (d) 9 Gold, 5 Silver and 5 Bronze medals

Answer: (a)

India secure 19 medals, finish runner-up at Asian U-20 Athletics Championships in Hong Kong

- **India delivered a historic campaign at the Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026 in Hong Kong China, finishing second in the standings with 19 medals - 10 gold, five silver and four bronze.**
- The runner-up finish marked India's best-ever performance at the continental track and field championships outside home soil.
- **China topped the medal standings** with 25 medals, including 14 gold, while India finished ahead of Japan, which placed third with 18 medals.

RANK	COUNTRY	GOLD	SILVER	BRONZE	TOTAL
1	CHN - China	14	9	2	25
2	IND - India	10	5	4	19
3	JPN - Japan	5	5	8	18
4	UAE - United Arab Emirates	5	0	1	6
5	QAT - Qatar	3	4	3	10
6	TPE - Chinese Taipei	2	6	4	12
7	KOR - Korea	2	4	6	12
8	SRI - Sri Lanka	2	2	4	8
9	KAZ - Kazakhstan	1	2	4	7
10	UZB - Uzbekistan	1	1	4	6
11	IRI - Iran	0	3	0	3
12	HKG - Hong Kong, China	0	2	1	3
13	PHI - Philippines	0	1	1	2
14	THA - Thailand	0	1	0	1
15	KSA - Saudi Arabia	0	0	2	2
16	MGL - Mongolia	0	0	1	1

- India had previously finished second only twice before - in 1992 and 1996 - when the championships were hosted in New Delhi.
- A total of 48 Indian athletes (30 men and 18 women) competed in Hong Kong China from May 28 to 31.
- Nipam becoming the first Indian medallist of the meet after winning bronze in the women's 100m.
- Nitin Gupta secured India's first gold by clinching the men's 5000m race walk title,

Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026: India's medal winners

Medal winners for India			
Medal	Athlete (medal)	Event	Mark
Gold	Nitin Gupta	Men's 5000m race walk	19:47.49s
Gold	Amanat Kamboj	Women's discus throw	52.24m
Gold	Rahul Jakhar	Decathlon	7185 points
Gold	Pooja Singh	Women's high jump	1.93m
Gold	Nikhil Chandrashekar	Men's 3000m steeplechase	9:25.44s
Gold	Shahnavaz Khan	Men's long jump	7.84m
Gold	Basant	Men's high jump	2.20m
Gold	Muskan	Women's 5000m	16:53.08s
Gold	Mogali Venkatram	Men's 800m	1:48.27
Gold	Team India	Women's 4x400m relay	3.38.07s

Asian U20 Athletics Championships 2026 medals tally

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	China	14	9	2	25
2	India	10	5	4	19
3	Japan	5	5	8	18

40. Which shipyard built INS Malwan and INS Mangrol?

INS मालवन और INS मंगरोल का निर्माण किस शिपयार्ड ने किया था?

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Hindustan Shipyard Limited
- (d) Cochin Shipyard Limited

Answer: (d)

Indian Navy to Induct Five Indigenous Naval Platforms

- The Indian Navy is set to induct five indigenously built naval platforms in June 2026, marking a significant boost to India's maritime capabilities and the government's Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative in defence manufacturing.
- The induction includes two Project 17A stealth frigates, one Survey Vessel Large (SVL), and two Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Crafts (ASW-SWC)



Indian Navy to Induct Five Indigenous Naval Platforms

- **INS Dunagiri** – Project 17A Stealth Frigate built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata.
- **INS Mahendragiri** – Project 17A Stealth Frigate built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai.

- **INS Sandhayak** – Survey Vessel Large (SVL) for hydrographic and navigational surveys.
- **INS Malwan** – Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) built by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL).
- **INS Mangrol** – Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) built by CSL.

IMPORTANT HEADLINES

Books & Appointments:

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh released a commemorative volume on Operation Sindoor, documenting the personal experiences and testimonies of 100 officers, sailors, airmen and soldiers who participated in the operation.
- Y. Balaji Kiran, a 2013-batch Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS) officer, has taken additional charge as the Chief Public Relations Officer (CPRO) of the South Coast Railway (SCoR).
- Maltese Prime Minister Robert Abela's governing center-left Labour Party won a historic, record-breaking fourth consecutive term.
- The Uttar Pradesh government has appointed senior IPS officer Rajeev Krishna as the state's new Director General of Police
- Air Marshal Tarun Chaudhry, AVSM, VSM assumed the appointment of Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Central Air Command on 01 Jun 2026.
- Canara Bank announced that Brajesh Kumar Singh has assumed charge as Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of the bank.
- Karnataka is set for a leadership transition on June 3, when D.K. Shivakumar will be sworn in as the State's new Chief Minister.
- Abhishek Trivedi assumed charge as the Executive Director In-charge of the Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL) Visakh Refinery.
- The Kerala government has appointed IAS officer Seeram Sambasiva Rao as the new Excise Commissioner.
- A 2013-batch Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS) officer, Y. Balaji Kiran, has been appointed Chief Public Relations Officer (CPRO) of the newly created South Coast Railway (SCoR) Zone, headquartered in Visakhapatnam.
- Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty assumed charge as the 20th Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC), India's only tri-service operational command, at Sri Vijaya Puram.
- Pope Leo XIV has appointed Mexican-American media executive Maria Montserrat Alvarado to head the Vatican's communications department, making history as the first non-religious woman to serve as prefect of a dicastery of the Holy See.
- Assam Legislative Assembly Speaker Ranjeet Kumar Dass granted Leader of Opposition status to senior Congress leader Wazed Ali Choudhury.
- Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh was given the additional charge of Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) Chairman

Awards & Obituaries:

- 17 Projects/ Initiatives selected for the National Awards for e-Governance 2026 across 7 Award categories
- The Yakshagana Kalaranga of Udupi has chosen Chandrashekara Damle, founder of the Tenkuthittu Hitarakshana Vedike, Sullia, for the Yakshagana Kalaranga award, 2026.
- For the first time, the Indian Haj Mission has received two prestigious Labbaytum Awards from the Saudi Ministry of Hajj and Umrah for excellence in Haj coordination and communication.
- Competition Commission of India (CCI) Chairman and retired IAS officer Dhanendra Kumar passed away after a fire erupted at his residence in South Delhi's Hauz Khas, He was 80 years old.
- Gujarat's Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA from Manjalpur Yogesh Patel died

- Pahlaj Nihalani, the veteran producer and former chairperson of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC), has passed away. He was 76.
- Veteran playback singer Suman Kalyanpur, a recipient of the Padma Bhushan and celebrated voice in Hindi and Marathi cinema, has died at the age of 89.

National NEWS:

- The Supreme Court recently observed that the doctrine of promissory estoppel cannot be invoked to claim a benefit under a government policy which was never aimed to benefit a specific class of industrial unit.
- The Prime Minister Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) scheme has completed six years of public implementation since its initial launch in June 2020
- The Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C.R. Patil launched the 'Swachh Gaon, Surakshit Jalvayu' (SGSJ) campaign and the National level IEC Campaign for awareness on Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 at the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation, Ministry of Jal Shakti, in New Delhi
- Recently, the Union Minister of Science & Technology launched the MAHA Water Mission.
- Recently, the Forest Advisory Committee (FAC) has granted in-principle approval for the diversion of over 3,000 hectares of forest land across several states for key infrastructure projects.
- Recently, the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG), Government of India, launched the Portal for the National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment (NeSDA), 2025.
- The Supreme Court upheld the 28% GST on the full face value of bets placed on real-money gaming platforms.
- Recently, the Department of Youth Affairs, Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, through Mera Yuva Bharat commenced the first phase of the Viksit Vibrant Village Program (VVVP) 2026.
- Minister of State for Commerce and Industry Shri Jitin Prasada Inaugurates Global Business Research Conference 2026 at IIFT
- The Union Cabinet approved the construction of a new coastal highway from Rameshwar to Paradeep in Odisha at a total project cost of ₹8,300.79 crore.
- Cabinet approves ₹10,000 crore ATF price stabilisation fund to shield airlines, jet fuel prices
- Cabinet approves Scheme for support to NCRPB for replacement of old trucks and buses in Delhi-NCR area
- Recently, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE), Government of India launched 'Navachar Mantra' Initiative.
- The Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education officially opened applications for the Prime Minister Research Chair (PMRC) Scheme 2026.
- 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan' to be carried out across the country from June 1 to June 30
- The Department of School Education & Literacy (DoSEL), Ministry of Education, flagged off a contingent of 56 Indian school students to visit Japan.
- The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) has released the National Family Health Survey -6 (NFHS-6) report for the 2023-24 period.

State NEWS:

- Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena dedicated 15 common facility centres (CFCs) across the Union territory to strengthen micro-enterprises, generate livelihood opportunities for women and youth within their own villages and help reduce migration.
- The Central government of India approved the Chenab-Beas Link Tunnel project in May 2026.
- Delhi CM announces 'Menstrual Health Matters' campaign
- Recently, the Valley of Flowers national park located in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand has been opened to tourists.
- Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh in Lucknow jointly with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath inaugurated the 'Nausena Shaurya Vatika', an open-air naval museum.

- Madhya Pradesh Government will soon relaunch a state-wide public transport bus service, which was discontinued in 2005, The bus service 'Mukhya Mantri Sugam Parivahan Sewa'
- The Kshipra riverine system in Madhya Pradesh is facing a major crisis marked by the drying up of its tributaries that fail to maintain a perennial flow.
- A new study has reconstructed nearly 4,000 years of climate and vegetation history of Majuli Island in Assam.
- Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh took an oath as President of the Lainingthou Sanamahi Temple Board at a ceremony held at the Lainingthou Sanamahi Temple Complex in Imphal.
- 'Operation Mule Hunt' exposes ₹2,289 crore cyber fraud network in Gujarat; 638 arrested
- The National Steering Committee (NSC) has approved the strategic investment plan for the Visakhapatnam ITI Cluster in Andhra Pradesh submitted by ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India under the Rs 60,000 crore PM-SETU scheme.
- In Borpada village in Madhya Pradesh's Jhabua district, residents revived the Bhil tradition of Halma to clean and restore a public well.
- Kerala-based fabless semiconductor startup Netrasemi launched its flagship AI system-on-chip, the A2000,
- The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) recently removed the walls built inside the main gopuram of Virupaksha Temple, where a mantapa was converted into an office.
- Bidar district of Karnataka has emerged as a winner of the Centre's Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari Award given to top performing districts under the campaign, Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain.
- Gujarat Police Arrest 362 Illegal Bangladeshi Nationals Under 'Operation Delta Hunt'
- The Fotu La Tunnel project on National Highway-01 in Ladakh has been approved with an estimated cost of ₹1,196.22 crore.
- Assam will launch a statewide plantation drive on World Environment Day, 5 June 2026, to plant one crore saplings across the state.
- A remote village of just 91 people near the India-China border is set to become the site of India's first Model Border Village.
- The Gujarat Cabinet granted in-principle approval to the ambitious 'Gujarat Wire-Free City Mission', a statewide initiative aimed at shifting overhead electricity distribution lines underground across urban areas by 2030.
- The Kerala Governor Rajendra Arlekar announced two key policy decisions of the new government which can have significant impact on the State's public health -- a new department for senior citizens' welfare
- Operation Chakravyuh: DRI seizes 24 kg of narcotics in Kerala
- Kadamparai Pumped Storage Hydro Power Plant, Tamil Nadu's only facility with reversible two-way turbines, is struggling to stay operational as it is beyond its design life, functioning at just 25% capacity.
- The probability of the Mettur dam in Tamil Nadu getting opened on the scheduled date appears to be remote, in view of the poor storage and the forecast of a poor southwest monsoon (June-September) this year.
- The Government of India notified two new Special Economic Zones (SEZs) in the Union Territory of Puducherry. The proposals were cleared by the Board of Approval for SEZs, functioning under the Department of Commerce.

DEFENCE, SCIENCE TECHNOLOGY, ENVIRONMENT:

- A new System for Pension Administration Raksha (SPARSH) Service Centre of the Defence Accounts Department, Government of India, was inaugurated at the NCC Canteen premises
- Recently, INS Sudarshini visited Antigua after successfully completing a historic trans-Atlantic passage as part of the ongoing Lokayan 26 expedition.
- The U.S. military fired a Hellfire missile at a tanker heading toward Iran recently as part of a blockade being imposed by President Donald Trump
- Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated the 37th Raising Day of Project UDAYAK.

- Bharti Airtel's launch of India's first consumer-focused 5G network slicing plan, called 'Priority Postpaid,' has ignited a fresh regulatory debate over net neutrality.
- Space start-up Bellatrix Aerospace will help South Korean space company TelePIX in an upcoming Very Low Earth Orbit (VLEO) satellite mission.
- NASA and the European Space Agency announced methane detection on the interstellar comet 3I/ATLAS using the James Webb Space Telescope.
- Recently, a rare Himalayan Brown Bear (*Ursus arctos isabellinus*) has been captured on camera inside the Gangul Siyabehi Wildlife Sanctuary in Chamba of Himachal Pradesh.
- Visuals of a massive dust storm in Churu on May 30 have been going viral on social media. — Dust storms primarily originating from the Thar Desert are not unusual over northern India in the pre-monsoon months of April to June.
- NASA declared the Mars Atmosphere and Volatile Evolution (MAVEN) mission concluded on 3 June 2026 after a prolonged loss of contact with the spacecraft.
- Paleontologists have identified a new, distinct species of massive Cretaceous-era marine reptile named *Tylosaurus rex* after re-examining previously misidentified fossils, including a famous 13.2 meter specimen nicknamed Bunker.
- Indian botanists recently identified a previously unknown species of flowering plant named *Crotalaria phulei* from forests of Nagpur.
- A new species of lizard, *Mesalina Bishnoi*, has been recently discovered in Rajasthan.
- Recently, scientists from the Botanical Survey of India have discovered a new species of moss and named it as *Indopotia himalayensis*.
- Recently, the Supreme Court has ordered the immediate removal of encroachers and demolition of illegal structures across the ecologically sensitive Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve landscape in South India.
- Kaziranga National Park recently recorded its first sighting of the yellow-throated marten, highlighting Assam's conservation success.
- Mother Dairy, one of India's largest dairy brands, unveiled what they claim to be the country's first naturally degradable milk pouches for its cow milk variant.

INTERNATIONAL, INDEX & REPORTS:

- Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang unveiled the RTX Spark superchip at the Computex 2026 exhibition in Taipei.
- Austria, Kyrgyzstan, Portugal, Trinidad and Tobago, and Zimbabwe were elected as non-permanent members of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) for the year 2027-28,
- Project Patriot Pipeline is a workforce development initiative of the United States Department of War, announced by Secretary of War Pete Hegseth.
- India is the leading country of origin for immigrant founders of U.S. billion-dollar startup companies, with Indian-born entrepreneurs having founded or co-founded 96 unicorns in the United States, according to a new report by the National Foundation for American Policy (NFAP).
- Recently, the Aukus alliance members said that they will develop advanced underwater drone systems and further deepen their maritime relationship.
- Myanmar President U Min Aung Hlaing has assured Prime Minister Narendra Modi that Myanmar's territory will not be allowed to be used against India's security interests.
- India will host the second BRICS Culture Working Group meeting in Varanasi on June 4-5, the Ministry of Culture (MoC) announced,
- India will host the 13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum in New Delhi on June 11-12, bringing together ministers, policymakers and urban experts from member countries to discuss strategies for building inclusive, resilient and people-centric cities amid rapid urbanisation.

- India Seeks Protection from US Section 301 Tariffs, Section 301 is a provision of the United States Trade Act of 1974. It allows the United States Trade Representative to investigate foreign trade practices and to impose trade measures in response to unfair practices.
- Authorities in Georgia recently found a body in the Mtkvari River, believed to be missing Indian medical student, pending DNA confirmation.
- The Defence Secretary recently held a series of high-level bilateral engagements on the sidelines of the Shangri-La Dialogue 2026 in Singapore, focusing on strengthening defence partnerships, maritime security cooperation, and regional stability in the Indo-Pacific.

SPORTS & FINANCE:

- India claims men's freestyle crown, ends U23 Asian Wrestling Championships with 27 medals
- Paris Saint-Germain (PSG) successfully defended their Union of European Football Associations (UEFA) Champions League title by defeating Arsenal Football Club
- Former England midfielder James Milner has announced his retirement from football at the age of 40 after 24 seasons in the Premier League.
- Former world No. 1 pair Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty clinch their maiden Singapore Open title, defeating Indonesia's Fajar Alfian and Muhammad Shohibul Fikri in the men's doubles final of the Badminton World Federation (BWF) Super 750 tournament, in Singapore
- Sixteen-year-old mountaineer Nisha Sasikumar from Chennai has summited Mount Everest, becoming one of the youngest climbers in the world to scale the world's highest mountain via the South Col route from Nepal.
- A fourteen-year-old Indian-American student, Shrey Parikh, from California won the Scripps National Spelling Bee 2026, correctly spelling 32 words in 90 seconds
- E-commerce platform Meesho has partnered with the BSE to launch a new initiative aimed at helping micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and digital businesses transition into publicly-listed companies.
- The initiative, named 'Project Shikhar'
- The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) completes 10 years, enacted in 2016, has completed a decade of operation, establishing itself as a transformative institutional shift for India's credit markets and corporate accountability.

QUESTION OF THE DAY

Which of the following are features of the Prime Minister Research Chair (PMRC) Scheme 2026?

1. It aims to attract researchers of Indian origin working in leading foreign institutions.
2. It provides three tiers of engagement—Young Research Fellows, Senior Research Fellows and Research Chairs.
3. Only institutions ranked in the top 100 of NIRF Overall/Engineering categories or top 50 in NIRF Research category are eligible to host fellows.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

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